

SBS Custom Style



USER MANUAL

Backend theme, branding and productivity controls for Odoo 19 Community

DOCUMENT DETAILS

Module	sbs_custom_style
Version	19.0.1.1.0
Odoo version	19.0 (Community Edition only)
Category	Themes / Backend
Author	Star Bit Solutions
Licence	LGPL-3
Document	User Manual

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1. Introduction

SBS Custom Style is a backend theme and productivity layer for Odoo Community. It brings together six things that are usually chased as separate add-ons: an apps sidebar, brandable colours, a themed login page, per-user layout choices, grouped-list controls, and a way to refresh views.

Who decides what

The split matters, because it determines who you send where.

Decided by	Where	What
An administrator , once, for everyone	Settings > General Settings > SBS Custom Style	Light and dark colour palettes, sidebar and menu colours, apps-menu background, sidebar logo, favicon, and the login page background.
Each user , for themselves	Preferences, from the user menu	Sidebar type, chatter position and dialog size.

Nobody needs permission to lay out their own screen.

The three per-user settings are ordinary preferences. A user who prefers no sidebar, or the chatter below the form, simply sets it and it applies to them alone.

2. Prerequisites

Requirement	Detail
Odoo version	Odoo 19, tested on Community Edition.
Depends on	<code>base_setup</code> , <code>web</code> , <code>mail</code> , <code>bus</code> , <code>base_automation</code> .
Live refresh	Push refresh uses Odoo's bus, so longpolling must work as it does for chat notifications.
Translations	German, Spanish, French and Italian are supplied.
Licence	LGPL-3

This module cannot be installed on Odoo Enterprise.

It excludes `web_enterprise` , which is always present on Enterprise, because it provides the Community equivalent of that backend styling. On Enterprise the installation is refused. This is deliberate, not a defect.

Installing

- 1 Place the `sbs_custom_style` folder in a directory on your Odoo `addons_path` .
- 2 Restart the Odoo service.
- 3 Open **Apps**, remove the *Apps* filter, search for **SBS Custom Style** and press **Activate**.
- 4 Refresh the browser. The apps sidebar appears immediately with default colours.

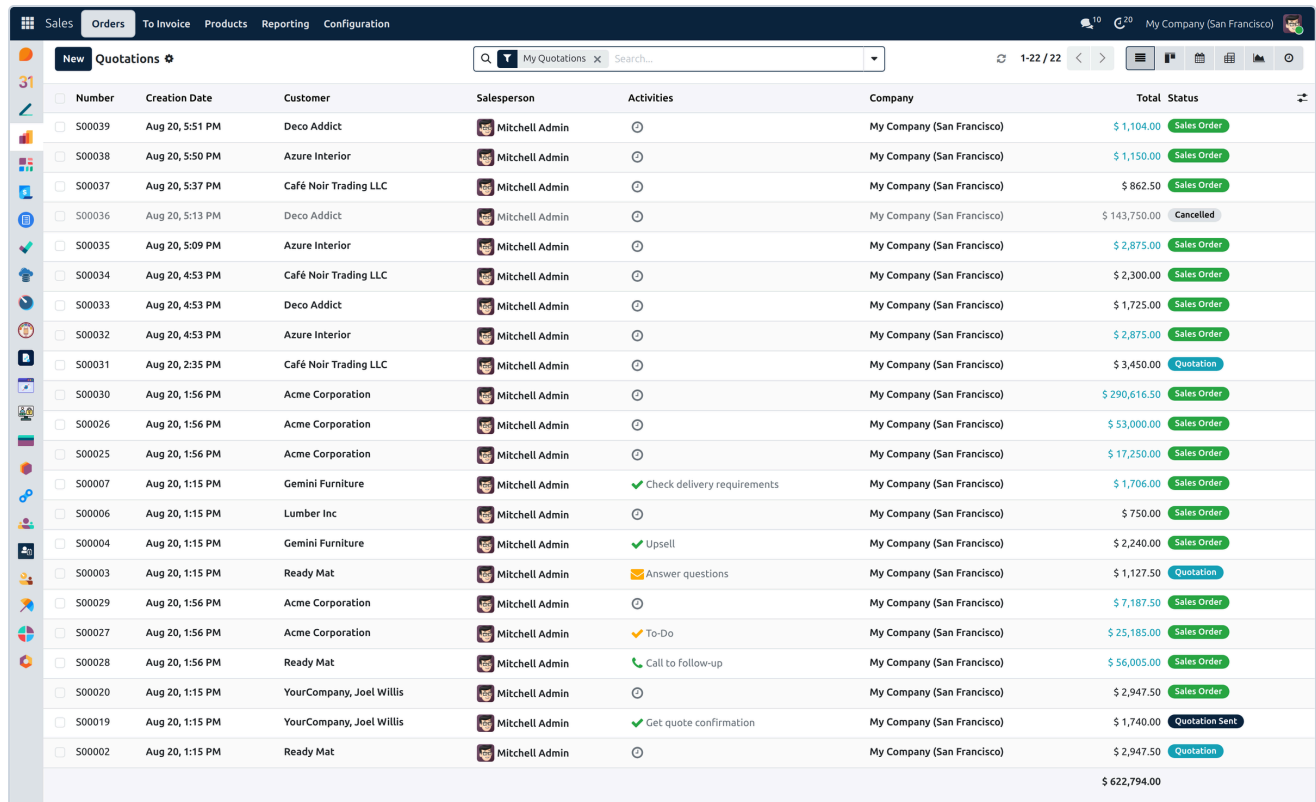
3. The Apps Sidebar

The sidebar lists every application the user is allowed to open, permanently down the left edge, so moving between apps no longer means a trip through the apps grid.

Setting	What you get	Suits
Large	Icons with application names.	Most users, and anyone still learning where things live.
Small	Icons only, in a narrow strip.	Experienced users who want the width back but still want one-click access.
Invisible	No sidebar at all — the stock Odoo layout.	Small screens, or users who prefer the apps grid.

Number	Creation Date	Customer	Salesperson	Activities	Company	Total	Status
S00039	Aug 20, 5:51 PM	Deco Addict	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 1,104.00	Sales Order
S00038	Aug 20, 5:50 PM	Azure Interior	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 1,150.00	Sales Order
S00037	Aug 20, 5:37 PM	Café Noir Trading LLC	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 862.50	Sales Order
S00036	Aug 20, 5:13 PM	Deco Addict	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 143,750.00	Cancelled
S00035	Aug 20, 5:09 PM	Azure Interior	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 2,875.00	Sales Order
S00034	Aug 20, 4:53 PM	Café Noir Trading LLC	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 2,300.00	Sales Order
S00033	Aug 20, 4:53 PM	Deco Addict	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 1,725.00	Sales Order
S00032	Aug 20, 4:53 PM	Azure Interior	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 2,875.00	Sales Order
S00031	Aug 20, 2:35 PM	Café Noir Trading LLC	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 3,450.00	Quotation
S00030	Aug 20, 1:56 PM	Acme Corporation	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 290,616.50	Sales Order
S00026	Aug 20, 1:56 PM	Acme Corporation	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 53,000.00	Sales Order
S00025	Aug 20, 1:56 PM	Acme Corporation	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 17,250.00	Sales Order
S00007	Aug 20, 1:15 PM	Gemini Furniture	Mitchell Admin	Check delivery requirements	My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 1,706.00	Sales Order
S00006	Aug 20, 1:15 PM	Lumber Inc	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 750.00	Sales Order
S00004	Aug 20, 1:15 PM	Gemini Furniture	Mitchell Admin	Upsell	My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 2,240.00	Sales Order
S00003	Aug 20, 1:15 PM	Ready Mat	Mitchell Admin	Answer questions	My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 1,127.50	Quotation
S00029	Aug 20, 1:56 PM	Acme Corporation	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 7,187.50	Sales Order
S00027	Aug 20, 1:56 PM	Acme Corporation	Mitchell Admin	To-Do	My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 25,185.00	Sales Order
S00028	Aug 20, 1:56 PM	Ready Mat	Mitchell Admin	Call to follow-up	My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 56,005.00	Sales Order
S00020	Aug 20, 1:15 PM	YourCompany, Joel Willis	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 2,947.50	Sales Order
S00019	Aug 20, 1:15 PM	YourCompany, Joel Willis	Mitchell Admin	Get quote confirmation	My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 1,740.00	Quotation Sent
S00002	Aug 20, 1:15 PM	Ready Mat	Mitchell Admin		My Company (San Francisco)	\$ 2,947.50	Quotation
						\$ 622,794.00	

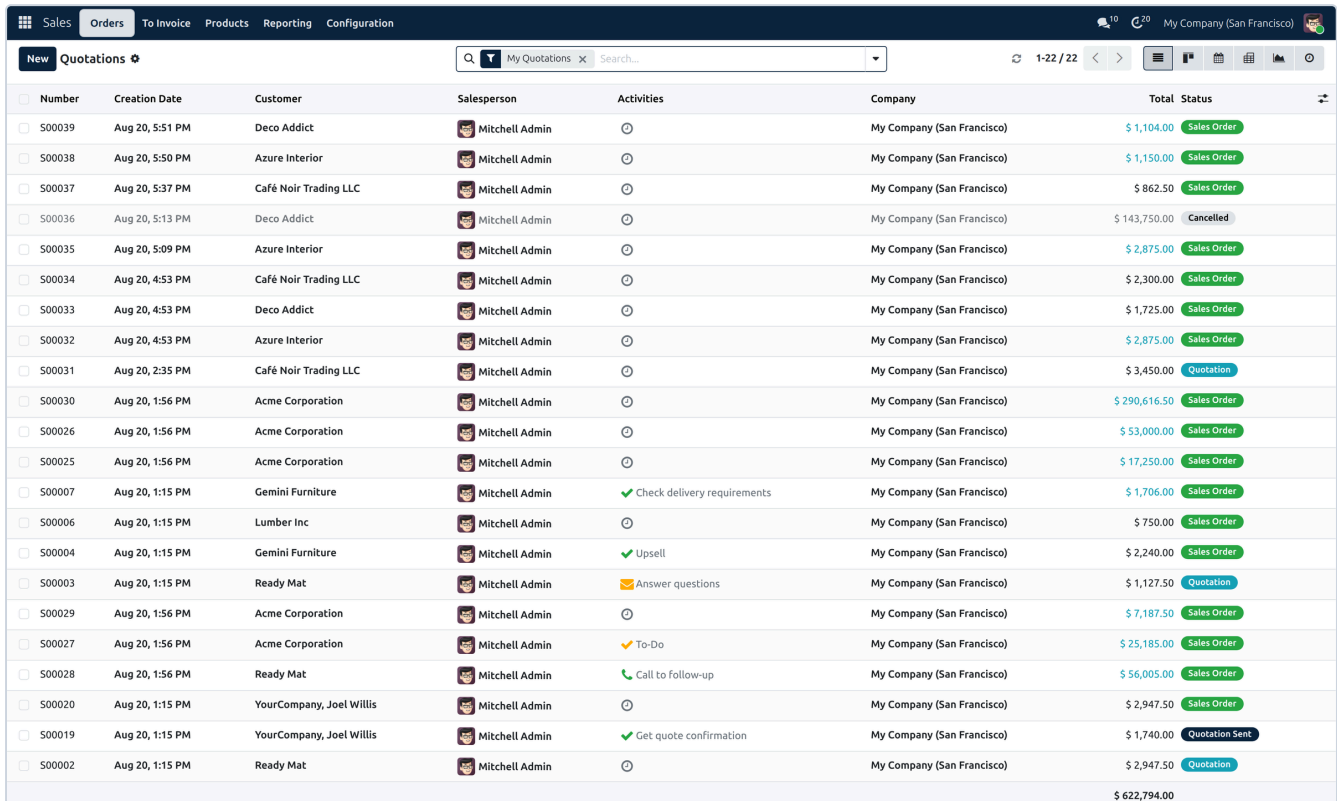
Figure 1 — Sidebar set to Large: icons with names.



The screenshot shows the Odoo Quotations list view. The sidebar on the left is set to 'Small: icons only', displaying a vertical list of application icons. The main table contains 20 rows of quotation data. The 'Activities' column includes various status icons and labels like 'Check delivery requirements', 'Upsell', 'Answer questions', 'To-Do', and 'Call to follow-up'. The 'Status' column shows buttons for 'Sales Order', 'Quotation', and 'Quotation Sent'. The total amount at the bottom is \$ 622,794.00.

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						\$ 622,794.00	

Figure 2 — Sidebar set to Small: icons only.



The screenshot shows the Odoo Quotations list view with the sidebar set to 'Invisible'. The sidebar area is now empty, and the table content has expanded to fill the full width of the screen. The data and layout are identical to Figure 2.

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						\$ 622,794.00	

Figure 3 — Sidebar set to Invisible: the full width returns to the record.

Choosing a default for a new team.

Large is the friendliest starting point. People who find it wasteful will discover Small on their own once they know the icons.

4. Chatter Position and Dialog Size

4.1 Where the chatter sits

On a wide screen, the chatter beside a record is convenient. On a dense form — a sales order with many columns, a wizard with a wide table — that same panel takes width the record needs.

Setting	Effect
Side	The chatter occupies a panel to the right of the form. This is the default.
Bottom	The chatter moves below the form, giving the record the full width of the screen.

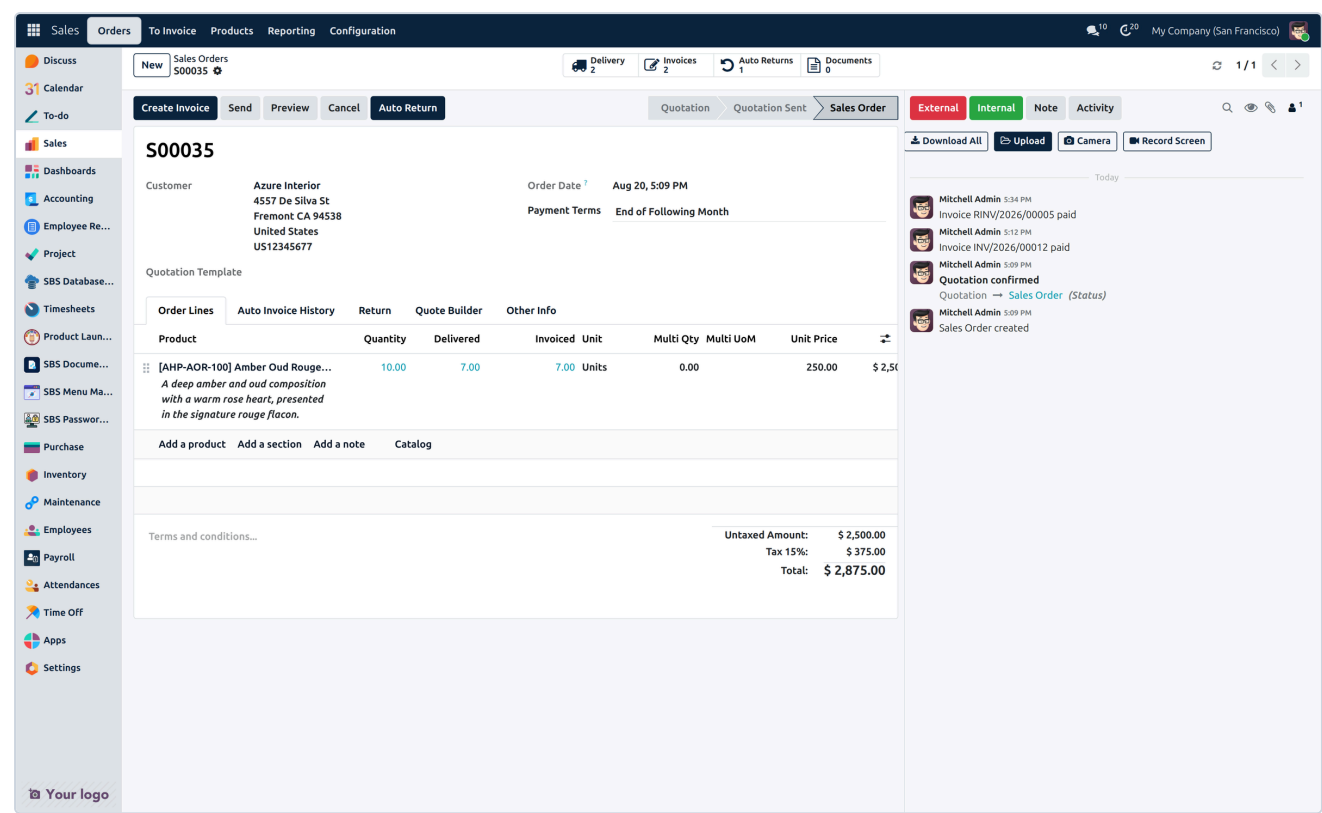


Figure 4 — Chatter at the side, the default arrangement.

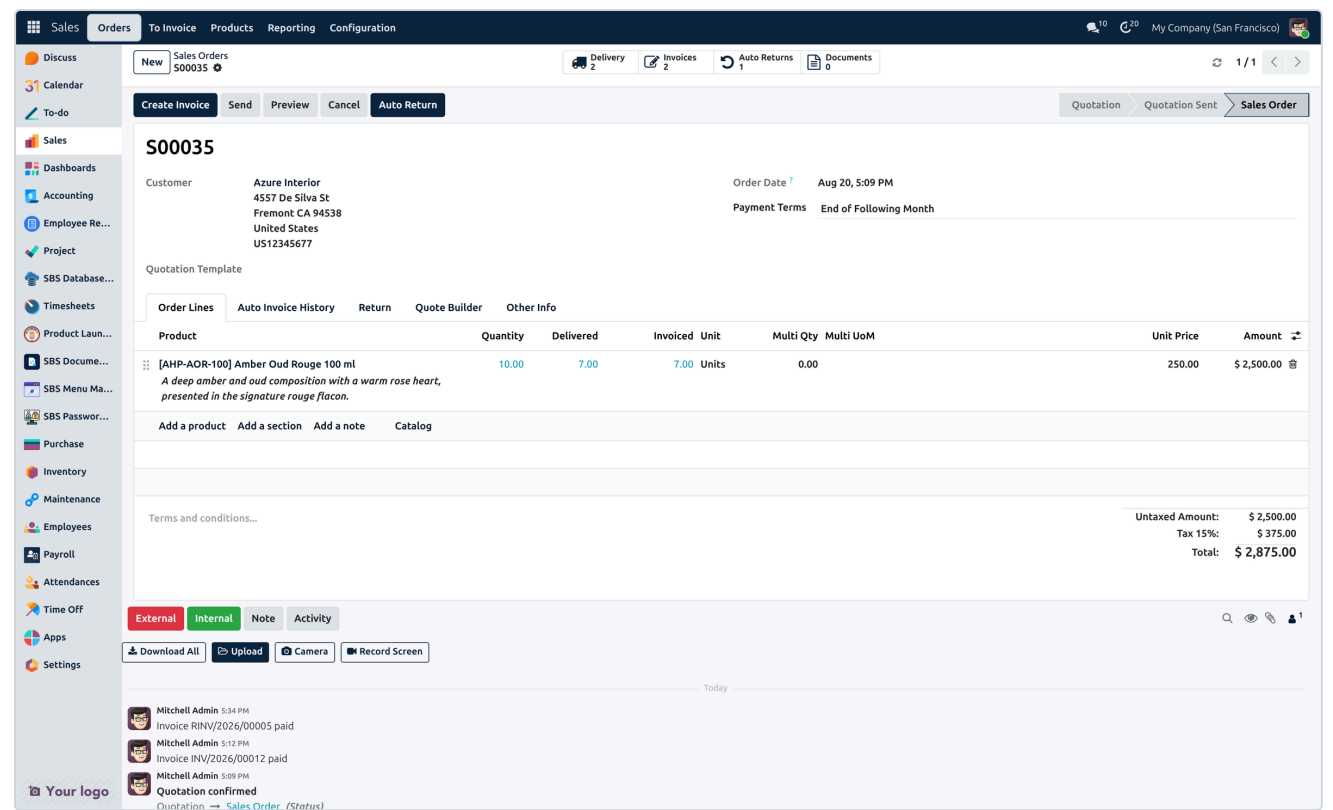


Figure 5 — The same record with the chatter moved below, giving the form the whole width.

4.2 How big dialogs open

Odoo's dialogs are compact by design. That is right for a confirmation and awkward for a report wizard with a dozen filters.

Setting	Effect
Minimize	Dialogs open at Odoo's standard size. This is the default.
Maximize	Dialogs open using much more of the screen.

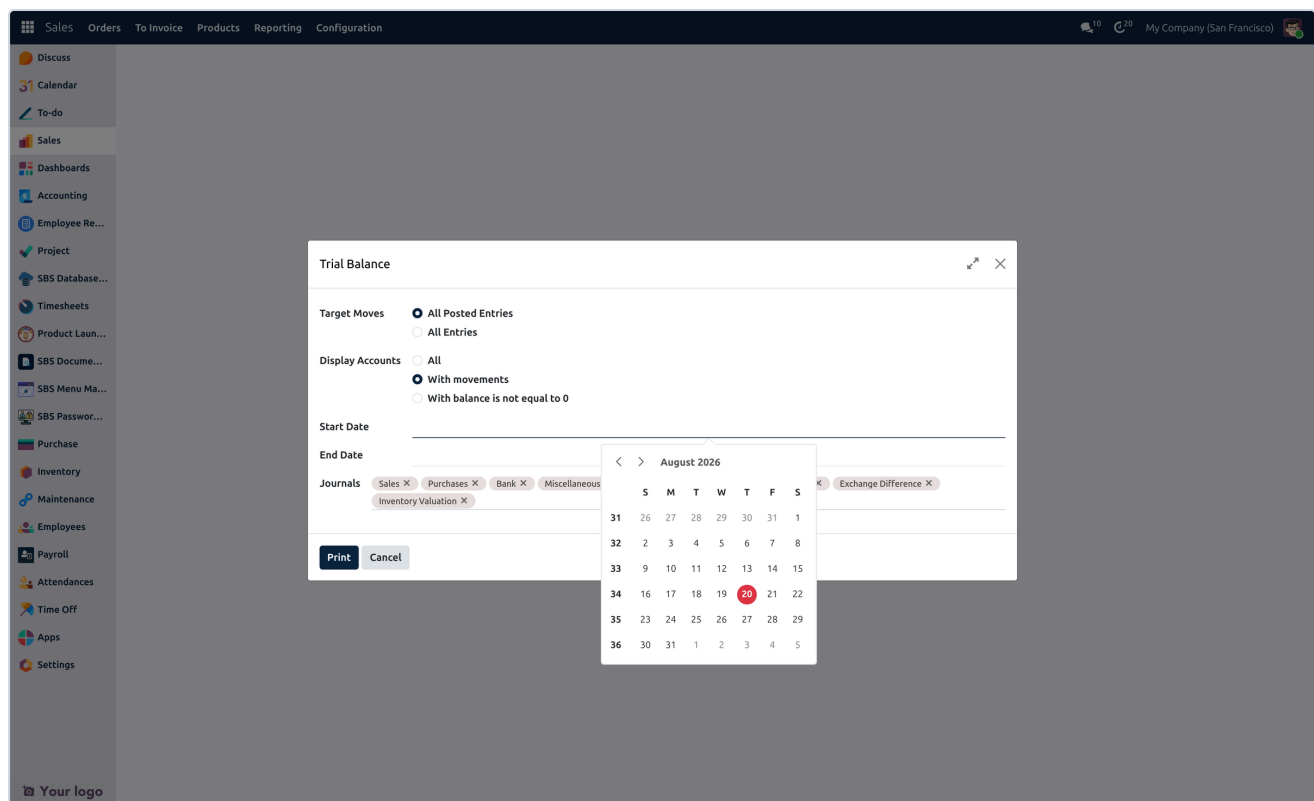


Figure 6 — A report wizard at the standard dialog size.

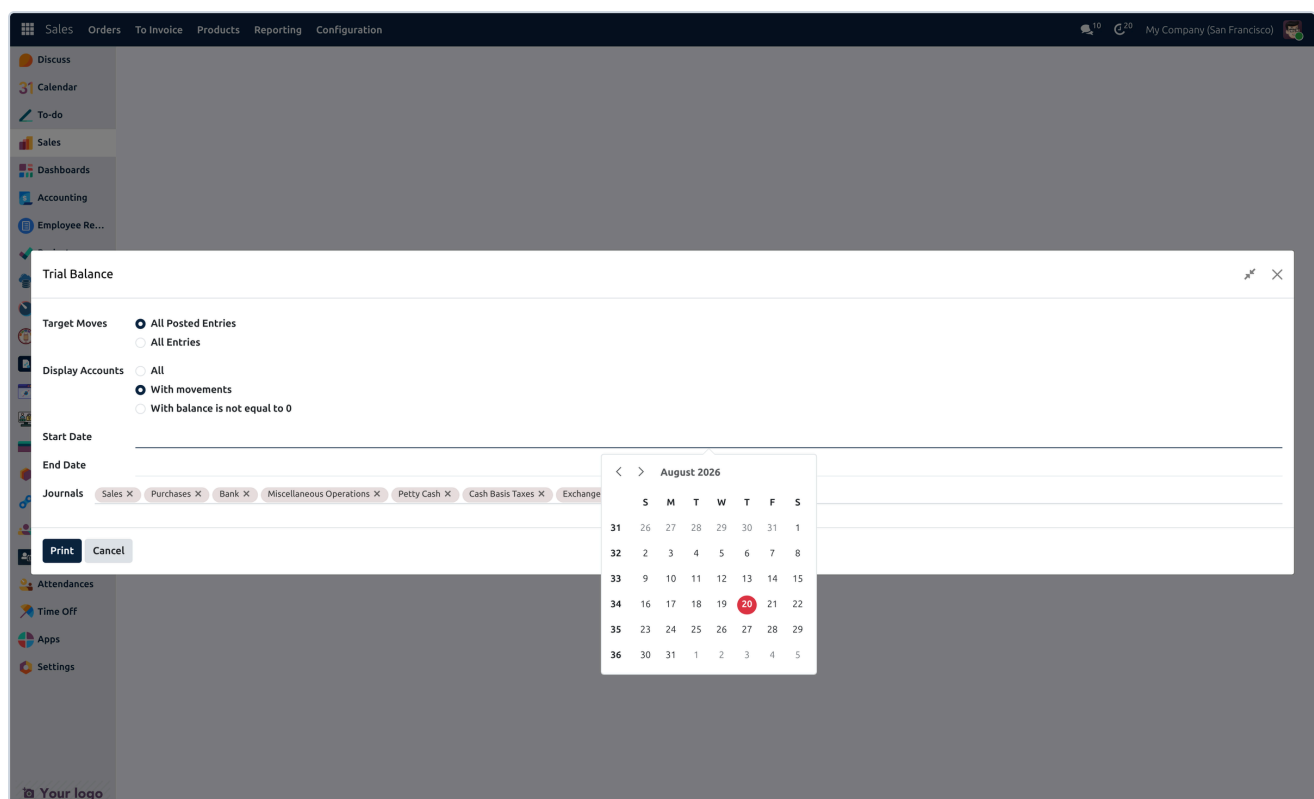


Figure 7 — The same wizard with dialogs set to maximise.

Nothing else changes.

The dialog contains exactly the same fields and buttons; only the space it is given differs.

4.3 Setting them

- 1 Click your avatar in the top right and choose **Preferences**.
- 2 On the **Preferences** tab, set **Sidebar Type**, **Chatter Position** and **Dialog Size**.
- 3 Press **Update Preferences**.
- 4 Refresh the browser if the sidebar does not change immediately.

Change My Preferences



Email

Phone

Preferences

Calendar

Security

Language ?

English (US)

Notification ?

☒ By Emails ☐ In Odoo

Email Signature

Default Warehouse

Sidebar Type

Large

Chatter Position

Side

Dialog Size

Minimize

Update Preferences

Discard

Figure 8 — The three settings on the user's own preferences.

5. Branding the Interface

Everything an administrator controls lives in one block under **Settings** > **General Settings**. Search the settings page for “SBS Custom Style” to jump straight to it.

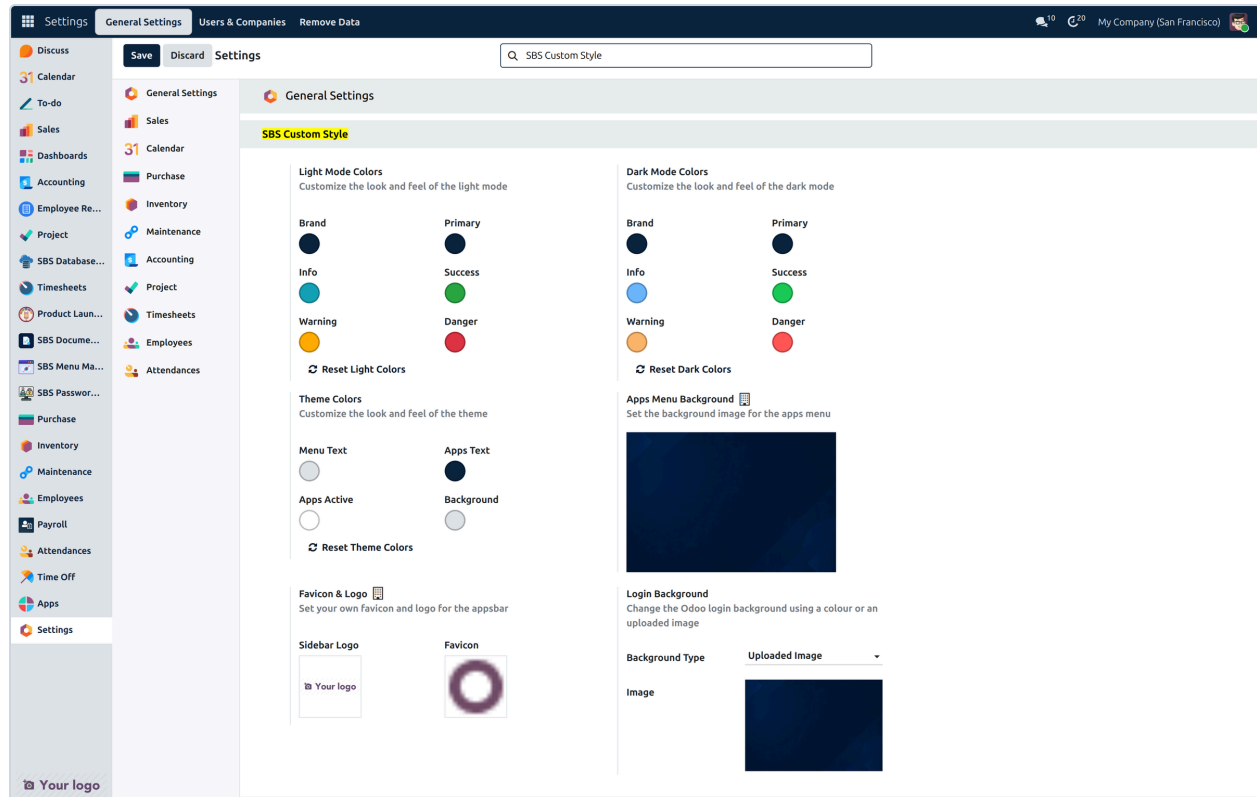


Figure 9 — The complete SBS Custom Style settings block.

5.1 Colours

Group	What it controls
Light Mode Colors	Brand, Primary, Info, Success, Warning and Danger as they appear in light mode.
Dark Mode Colors	The same six colours as they appear in dark mode, set independently.
Theme Colors	Apps menu text, apps bar text, the active app highlight, and the apps bar background.

- 1 Click a colour swatch and choose a new colour.
- 2 Press **Save** at the top of the settings page.
- 3 Refresh the browser to see the change applied.

Set light and dark separately, and check both.

A brand colour that reads well on a white background can disappear on a dark one. Each group has its own **Reset** link, so you can always return to the supplied defaults.

Colour changes rebuild the interface stylesheets.

Save once and refresh, rather than saving after each individual swatch.

5.2 Logo, favicon and backgrounds

Setting	Effect
Sidebar Logo	The logo shown at the foot of the apps sidebar.
Favicon	The icon shown in the browser tab.
Apps Menu Background	A background image behind the apps grid.
Login Background	A flat colour or an uploaded image behind the login form.

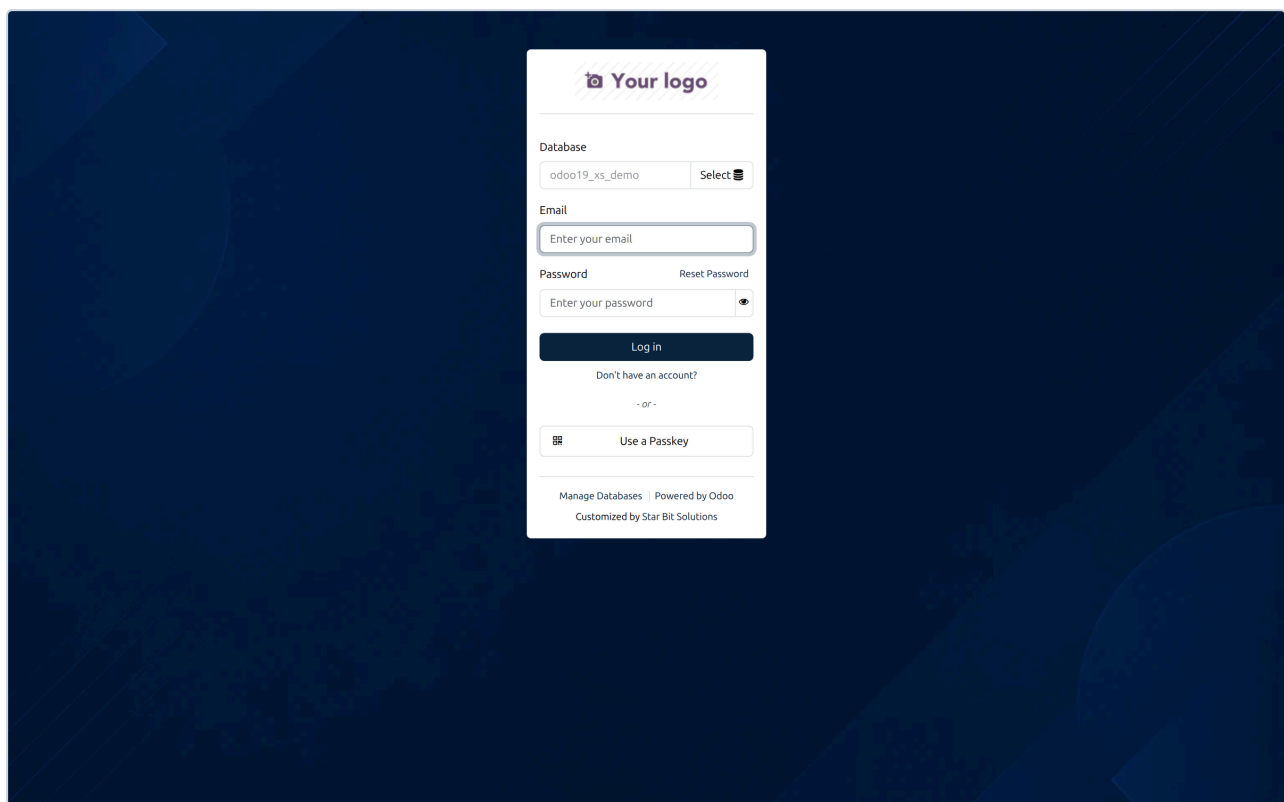


Figure 10 — The login page with a custom background image.

Branding before login.

The login background applies to anyone reaching the system, so it is the first thing people see each morning.

6. Working With Grouped Lists

When a list is grouped — a ledger by account, a pipeline by stage — opening each group in turn is tedious. This module adds two entries to the list's action menu.

- 1 Open a list view and apply a grouping.
- 2 Open the action menu beside the view title.
- 3 Choose **Expand All** to open every group, or **Collapse All** to close them.

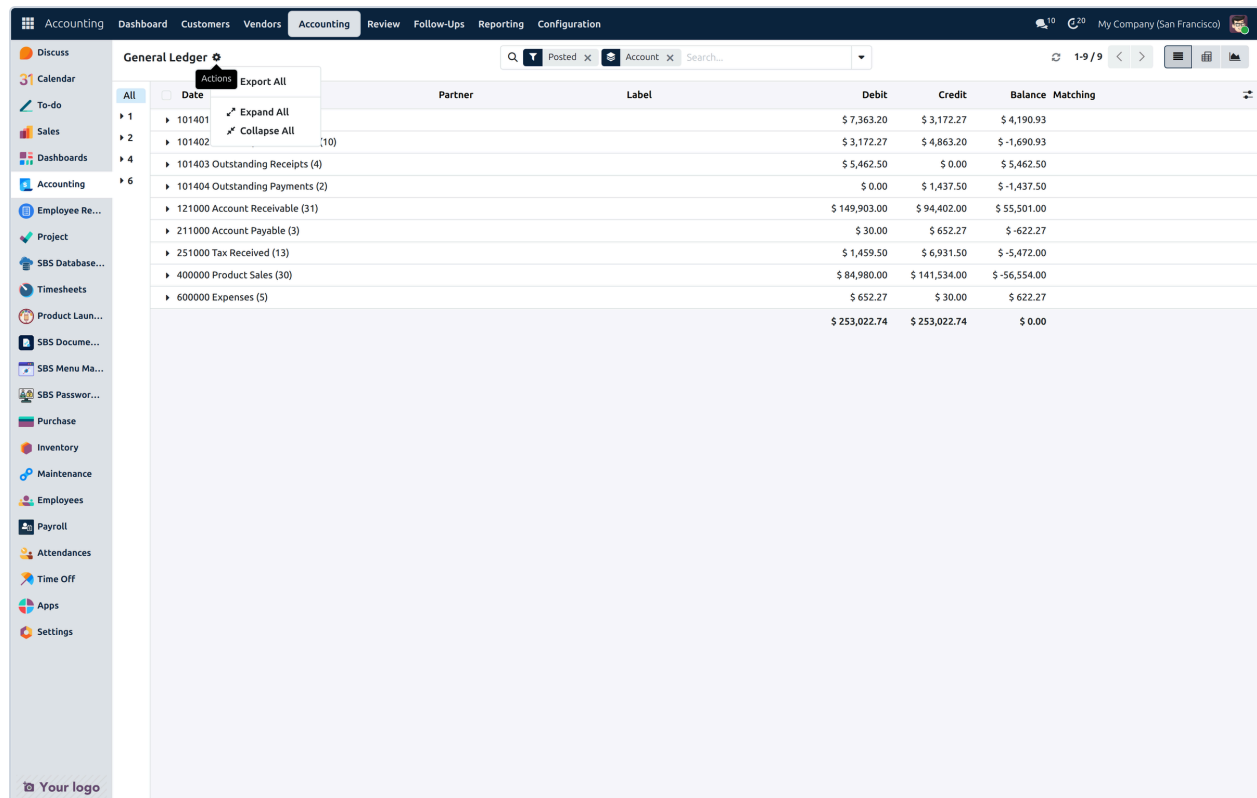


Figure 11 — Expand All and Collapse All in the list's action menu.

The screenshot displays the Odoo Accounting General Ledger. The interface includes a top navigation bar with tabs for Dashboard, Customers, Vendors, Accounting (active), Review, Follow-Ups, Reporting, and Configuration. A left sidebar contains various application icons. The main content area shows a table of journal entries with columns for Date, Journal Entry, Partner, Label, Debit, Credit, Balance, and Matching. The entries are grouped by date, with expandable arrows next to each date. The total balance at the bottom is \$253,022.74.

All	Date	Journal Entry	Partner	Label	Debit	Credit	Balance	Matching
1	101401 Bank (11)				\$ 7,363.20	\$ 3,172.27	\$ 4,190.93	
2	101402 Bank Suspense Account (10)				\$ 3,172.27	\$ 4,863.20	\$ -1,690.93	
4	101403 Outstanding Receipts (4)				\$ 5,462.50	\$ 0.00	\$ 5,462.50	
6	101404 Outstanding Payments (2)				\$ 0.00	\$ 1,437.50	\$ -1,437.50	
	121000 Account Receivable (31)				\$ 149,903.00	\$ 94,402.00	\$ 55,501.00	
	211000 Account Payable (3)				\$ 30.00	\$ 652.27	\$ -622.27	
	251000 Tax Received (13)				\$ 1,459.50	\$ 6,931.50	\$ -5,472.00	
	400000 Product Sales (30)				\$ 84,980.00	\$ 141,534.00	\$ -56,554.00	
	600000 Expenses (5)				\$ 652.27	\$ 30.00	\$ 622.27	
					\$ 253,022.74	\$ 253,022.74	\$ 0.00	

Figure 12 — A grouped list, ready to be expanded or collapsed in one action.

They appear only when a grouping is active.

On an ungrouped list there is nothing to expand, so the entries are not offered.

7. Refreshing Views

7.1 Refreshing your own view

A refresh control sits in the control panel, beside the record counter. It reloads the data in the current view without a full browser reload, which keeps your filters, grouping and scroll position.

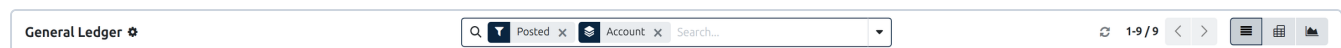


Figure 13 — The refresh control in the control panel.

7.2 Pushing a refresh to everyone

More usefully, the module adds a server action type called **Reload Views**. Running it tells every connected user viewing that model to reload, so people are looking at current data without being asked to press F5.

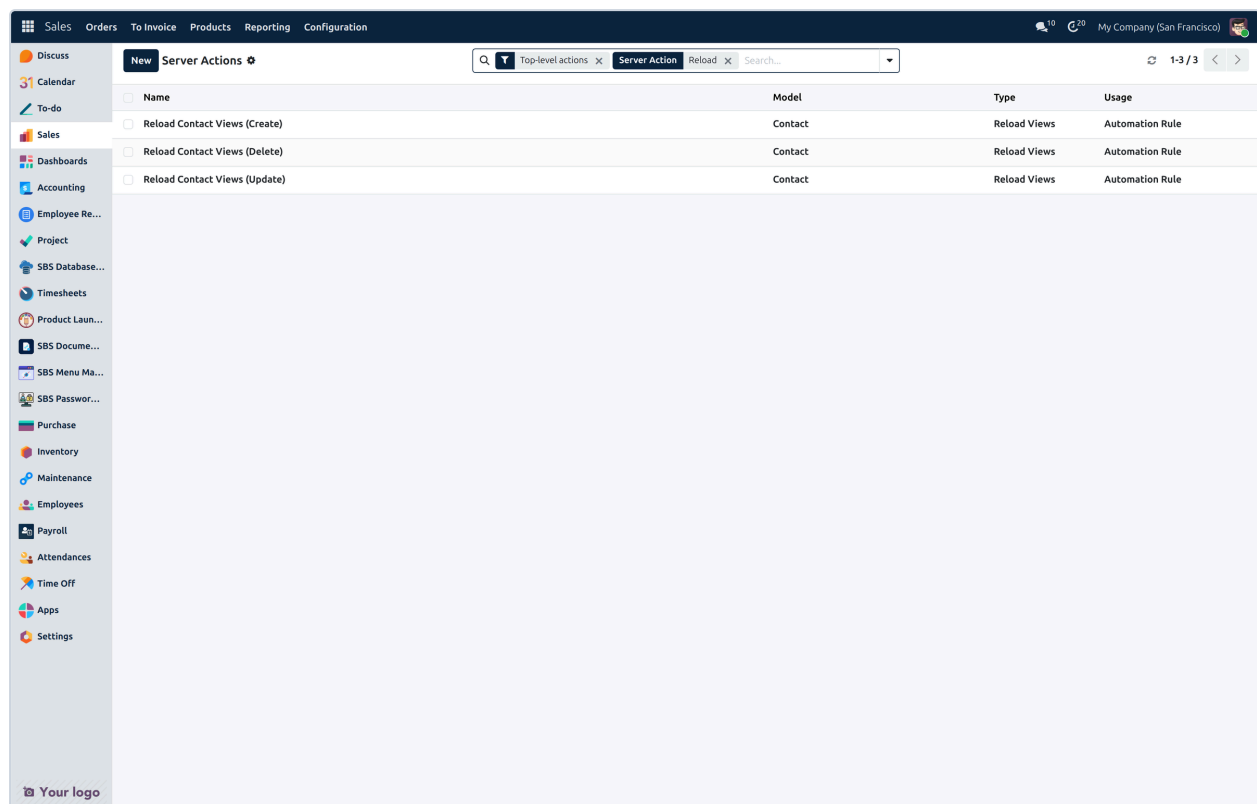


Figure 14 — The Reload Views server action type.

- 1 Go to **Settings > Technical > Server Actions** and press **New**.
- 2 Choose the **Model** whose views should reload.
- 3 Set the action type to **Reload Views**.
- 4 Optionally list the **View Types** to reload, comma separated, for example `list, kanban`. Leave it empty to reload every view type.

- 5 Save, and either run it manually or attach it to an automation rule.

Use it for	Why
A nightly import or synchronisation	Everyone with the list open sees the new records without being told.
A status change that others are watching	A dispatch board or a queue refreshes itself as work moves.
After a bulk update	Avoids people acting on figures that changed a minute ago.

Restrict the view types when you can.

Reloading form views can interrupt someone who is mid-edit. Limiting the action to `list`, `kanban` refreshes the boards people are watching without disturbing anyone typing into a record.

It needs the bus.

Push refresh travels over Odoo's longpolling bus, the same channel chat notifications use. If chat notifications arrive live, this will too.

8. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause and what to do
The module will not install.	You are on Odoo Enterprise. This module excludes <code>web_enterprise</code> because it replaces that styling. It is Community only.
The sidebar has not appeared.	Refresh the browser after installing. If it is still missing, check the user's Sidebar Type preference is not set to Invisible.
A colour change had no effect.	Press Save at the top of the settings page, then refresh the browser. The interface stylesheets are rebuilt on save.
Colours look wrong in dark mode.	Light and dark palettes are set separately. Adjust the Dark Mode Colors group, or press Reset Dark Colors to return to the defaults.
The login background did not change.	Check Background Type matches what you supplied — an uploaded image is ignored while the type is set to colour, and vice versa. Then reload the login page.
Expand All and Collapse All are missing.	They only appear while a grouping is active. Group the list first, then open the action menu.
Push refresh does not reach other users.	The bus is not delivering. Confirm live chat notifications work; if they do not, longpolling needs attention at the server level.
A reload interrupted someone editing a record.	Limit the Reload Views action's View Types to <code>list, kanban</code> so form views are left alone.
Users want different layouts.	That is supported. Sidebar type, chatter position and dialog size are per-user preferences, not company settings.